

ON THE RITUAL AND CEREMONIAL OF THE DAILY OFFICE

THE following comments on the ritual and ceremonial of the Prayer Book Offices, as contained in this volume, are suggestions gleaned from various sources. They represent an interpretation of the rubrics of the Prayer Book Offices according to ancient and set precedents, as found especially in the old Roman and Benedictine forms of the Divine Office, on which Matins and Evensong are directly based.

§ 1. *Recitation, Public and Private.*

RECITATION of the Daily Office may be public or private: *public*, meaning, recited by the Clergy and people in the parish church; or *private*, meaning, recited by clergymen or laity alone, in the privacy of their own homes. When the Office is said in private, none of the specific ceremonial rules regarding sitting, standing, kneeling, *etc.*, are understood as being obligatory. Thus the ceremonial directions set forth here refer primarily to the public recitation of the Office in the average parish church.

§ 2. *The Hour of Recitation.*

IN public recitation, Matins should be recited each day before the first Mass of the day, as it is technically an early morning service (being derived from the midnight vigil Office as well as from the early morning hours of Lauds and Prime). It has become customary in some places, however, on Sundays and high holy days, to recite Matins after the first Mass, and before the principal Mass of the day. Occasionally, such as on Christmas night (when multiple Masses are celebrated), Matins may be said in the late night, after Evensong. Evensong should be said sometime after 2 or 3 o'clock in the afternoon - the later the better (as it includes the ancient service of Compline, a late night, bedside office). In private recitation, however, these rules for the times of Matins and Evensong need not be followed so strictly.

§ 3. *The Voice and Mode of Recitation.*

THREE modes of recitation are used in the celebration of the Office. Some elements are (1) spoken without note, (2) others are chanted *recto tono* (that is, monotone), and (3) others are chanted according to plainchant (psalm tones, solemn canticle tones, florid modes, collect tones, *etc.*). The following chart illustrates the modes of recitation proper to each element of the Office:

OPENING SENTENCE	Without note
GENERAL CONFESSION	Without note
OPENING VERSICLES	Plainchant
INVITATORY AT MATINS	Plainchant
PSALMS OF THE DAY	Plainchant
FIRST LESSON	Lesson tone, <i>recto tono</i> , or without note
OFFICE HYMN	Properly plainchant
FIRST CANTICLE	Plainchant
SECOND LESSON	Lesson tone, <i>recto tono</i> , or without note
SECOND CANTICLE	Plainchant
APOSTLES' CREED	<i>Recto tono</i>
SUFFRAGES (PRECES)	Plainchant
OUR FATHER	<i>Recto tono</i>
COLLECT OF THE DAY	Collect tones, or <i>recto tono</i>
COMMEMORATIONS	Collect tones, or <i>recto tono</i>
SECOND & THIRD COLLECTS	Collect tones, or <i>recto tono</i>
CLOSING VERSICLES	Plainchant, or <i>recto tono</i>
THE ANTHEM	Plainchant, or other music
ADDITIONAL PRAYERS	Without note
THE GRACE	Without note

It may be noted that the portions of the Office which are spoken may be chanted *recto tono* for acoustical, not musical or liturgical, reasons.

Where musical resources are too limited for singing all of the portions of a sung Office, the Psalms of the day are the most important portion to sing. While the Invitatory Psalm and the Canticles are anciently and properly set to more solemn, florid tunes than the regular course of Psalms, simple Canticle tones may always be used in case of limited musical resources. In order to preserve the nature of the fully sung Office, if necessary the Collects and Closing Versicles may be sung *recto tono* also.

§ 4. *The Different Roles of the Office.*

THREE men are properly needed for a sung Office – the Officiant, the Precentor, and the Lector. The Officiant, a man in major Holy Orders (or at least minor orders, or a licensed lay Reader), is responsible for the Opening Sentence, the Opening Versicles, Creed, Suffrages, Our Father, Collects, additional Prayers, and the Grace. The Precentor is responsible for intoning, or beginning, the Psalms, Office Hymns, and Canticles. The Lector is responsible for reading the Lessons. Additionally, at Solemn Matins or Evensong (discussed below) the Officiant if he is a Priest should have two assistants (usually Deacon and Subdeacon), and a thurifer.

The Officiant should be seated at the sedilia (the seats or bench on the south side of the chancel). At a solemn office, the assistants (Deacon and Subdeacon) should also be seated with the Officiant at the sedilia. There should be a lectern from which the Lector reads the lessons. When the Lector and Precentor are not performing their functions, they may be seated with the congregation.

§ 5. *The Ceremonial of the Office.*

THE ceremonial of the Daily Office is fairly simple and subdued compared to that of the Mass. The Daily Offices of Matins and Evensong may be conducted as *simple* or *solemn*.

In the morning (especially Sunday morning), our best efforts go into singing the Mass reverently. This may make it impracticable to conduct solemn Matins, making simple sung or said Matins (in the practice of many parish churches) the best alternative. By contrast, it may be more frequently feasible to conduct Solemn Evensong, because all of the liturgical efforts go into one Office only. When liturgical resources are limited, a simple Office, whether sung or spoken without note, is appropriate. Although, when adequate resources are available, there is no reason why Matins and Evensong should not be rendered solemnly on a regular basis. A good balance might be solemn ceremonial on Sundays and greater feasts, and simple ceremonial on lesser feasts and ferias.

At a “solemn” Office the Officiant (if he is in major orders) is vested in cassock, surplice, as well as cope (of the color of the day). He should, if possible, be assisted by Deacon and Subdeacon, vested similarly in cassock, surplice and cope. If a Deacon and Subdeacon cannot be had, two Acolytes may accompany the Officiant. Six altar candles should be lighted. Incense is used at a

solemn Office, and the Altar is censed (in the same manner as at Mass) at the *Benedictus* or *Magnificat*. Additionally, at solemn Matins (according to some authorities) the cope is assumed by the Officiant only at the end of the *Psalms* of the Day, and he intones the *Te Deum*.

At a "simple" Office, however, the Officiant and the other ministers are vested only in cassock and surplice, and no incense is used. The Officiant may also wear biretta (and tippet, where customary). At least two candles should be lighted.

§ 6. *The Introduction to the Office.*

At the beginning of the Office, the Officiant and other ministers may proceed together from the sacristy into the chancel, make their bow or genuflexion before the Altar, and proceed to their proper places in the church.

To introduce the Daily Office, an appropriate Opening Sentence may be said, according to the time, season, or holy day (pp. 256-269). Then, there may be said the Exhortation and General Confession (p. 243-244), especially on penitential days (e.g. Wednesdays and Fridays throughout the year; ferial days in Advent, Lent, Passiontide; Ember Days; etc.). If a Priest is present, he may give the Absolution; if not, it is permissible for the Officiant to read the Collect for the Twenty-First Sunday after Trinity in the Book of Common Prayer ("Grant, we beseech thee, merciful Lord"). The Confession is recited by Officiant and people kneeling. The Absolution is read by a Priest standing, while the people are still kneeling.

§ 7. *The Opening Versicles.*

THEN, after the Opening Sentence and Confession, the Office proper is begun with the chanting of the Opening Versicles (p. 245-246). The solemn setting provided may be preferred on greater Sundays and high holy days; whereas the regular simple setting may be sung more often, on ordinary Sundays, lesser feasts, and ferias.

The Opening Versicles up to the *Gloria Patri* ("Glory be to the Father") are sung kneeling by Officiant and people. At the verse, "O Lord, open thou our lips," a small Sign of the Cross is made on the lips. At "O God, make speed to save us," a regular Sign of the Cross is made. At the *Gloria Patri*, all rise and bow (towards the Altar, according to some authorities).

The Opening Versicles are omitted on the last three days of Holy Week and in an Office for the commemoration of the dead (as on All Souls' Day).

§ 8. *The Invitatory Psalm, Venite, at Matins.*

AT Matins, there follows the chanting of the Invitatory Psalm, *Venite exultemus Domino* (p. 306). A seasonal Invitatory Antiphon, found on the even numbered pages facing the Psalm, may be sung before, throughout (at the indicated places) and after the Psalm. Every time the Antiphon is sung according to a Psalm tone, the intonation is sung, though the actual verses of the Psalm are not intoned throughout (only at the first verse). The proper posture at the *Venite* is standing. According to pious custom, a genuflexion is made at the verse "O come, let us worship and fall down . . ."

The exact method of chanting the *Venite* has varied over the centuries. Originally, it seems, a Precentor chanted the verses of the *Venite*, and the choir and people sung only the proper Invitatory Antiphon at the appointed places throughout the *Venite*. Later, perhaps as the Antiphons became more complex pieces of music, the Precentors sang the Antiphons, and perhaps the congregation sang the verses to a plainer tune. This volume contains different settings of the *Venite* for which one or the other aforementioned methods might be more appropriate. For instance, ancient Mode VI has fairly simple Antiphons and more ornate verses; whereas the Psalm Tone settings have simple verses with the option of using the more ornate Antiphons. The Prayer Book rubrics, however, contain no such directions.

In ancient use and in the English Prayer Books, the *Venite* is the whole of the 95th Psalm, whereas in the American Prayer Books it is in fact a combination of the 95th and 96th Psalms. Although the first usage is more correct and more ancient, the American *Venite* is also acceptable. Accordingly, both versions have been included in this volume.

The *Venite* should be omitted on the last three days in Holy Week. During Passiontide, or from Passion Sunday to Wednesday in Holy Week (inclusive), the *Gloria Patri* should not be recited here (except when the day is a festival). In Matins of the Dead and on All Souls' Day, the *Venite* is said, and the verses "Rest eternal grant unto them, O Lord / And may light perpetual shine upon them" replace the *Gloria Patri*.

The 1662 English Prayer Book directs that the *Venite* be omitted when "on the Nineteenth day of every Month it is not to be read here, but in the ordinary course of the Psalms." Many commentators point out that it makes much more sense, however, to instead omit Psalm 95 from the Psalms of the Day rather than to omit the Invitatory Psalm with its Antiphons.

§ 9. *The Eastertide Anthems, Pascha nostrum.*

ON Easter Day, instead of the *Venite*, the group of Antiphons called *Pascha nostrum* ("Christ our Passover is sacrificed for us") is sung (p. 342). The *Pascha nostrum* may also be sung throughout Easter Week.

§ 10. *The Psalms of the Day.*

THE Psalms of the Day (beginning on p. 1) follow immediately after the *Venite* at Matins, and the Opening Versicles at Evensong. The Prayer Book divides up the Psalter into thirty daily portions, morning and evening, so that the whole of the Psalter is recited each month. However, on certain occasions proper Psalms may be sung instead of the portion of Psalms according to the monthly system. The days on which proper Psalms are appointed are indicated in the third Appendix to the Psalter in this volume (p. 220).

The chanting of the Psalms forms the main core of the Daily Offices – the primitive core around which all the other elements of Matins and Evensong are formed. In light of this fact, the Psalms of the Day ought not to be omitted, shortened or downplayed in any way.

The intonation to each Psalm is sung by the Precentor, and the rest of the Psalm is sung antiphonally, that is, verse by verse (not half-verse by half-verse), the Precentor and the Congregation alternating, or (according to another, perhaps more correct custom) side to side (the left, "Gospel side" taking one verse, and the right, "Epistle side" the other, and so on). The *Gloria Patri* should likewise be chanted antiphonally.

The proper posture for the Psalms is sitting (as is understood from ancient monastic precedent, the chanting of the Psalms is properly a meditation). At each *Gloria Patri* all bow, and clergy remove their birettas. There are two other places in the Psalms where it is customary to bow: (1) "Holy and reverend is his Name" Psalm 111, and (2) "Blessed be the Name of the Lord," Psalm 113.

§ 11. *The First Lesson.*

A FIRST Lesson from the Old Testament, selected according to the lectionary system of the community, occurs at this point. The method of announcing and concluding the lessons may be found in the rubrics of the Ordinary (p. 247). All sit for the lessons.

The lessons should be read only by a man in Holy Orders, minor orders, or by a licenced lay reader. If this is not possible, they should be read at least by a

male adult in a cassock. If possible, the lessons might be read by different persons, the second being read by a clerk of higher rank than the first.

In accordance with the rubrics of the Breviary, the readers of the lessons may, at least on greater feast days, ask a blessing of the officiating Priest with the words "Bid, sir, a blessing." If a Priest reads a lesson, and there is no Bishop or senior Priest present from whom to ask a blessing, (or in the case of a minor clerk with no Priest present), he turns toward the Altar and says, "Bid, Lord, a blessing."

The lessons should be read or chanted from a lectern facing the people, so as to be well heard. In order that the lessons may be distinctly heard, it is praiseworthy to chant them according to the method described in Appendix II to the Ordinary (p. 270). The lessons may also be chanted *recto tono* (for acoustic reasons) or read without note.

The Prayer Book appoints no response of the people to the lessons in the Office; although, in the old Roman and Benedictine Office, at the end of the Lesson, the Reader says, "But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us" and the people respond, "Thanks be to God."

§ 12. *The Te Deum at Matins.*

At this point in Matins, after the first lesson, there follows the chanting of the hymn *Te Deum laudamus* (p. 351). The proper ancient setting of the *Te Deum* is the Ambrosian (in its original solemn form, or its later simplified form). However, simpler Psalm tone settings are provided also. The *Te Deum* is sung on the following occasions:

- (1) All Sundays (except in Advent and from Septuagesima to Passion Sunday inclusive);
- (2) Daily during Christmastide (that is, from December 25th to January 13th);
- (3) Daily throughout Eastertide (except on the Rogation Days);
- (4) On all feast days of any rank and throughout their octaves (except on Holy Innocents' Day when it is not on a Sunday or a feast of Title); and
- (5) In all Saturday Offices of the Blessed Virgin Mary.

The proper posture for the *Te Deum*, as for all the canticles, is standing. It is customary in some localities to bow toward the Altar at three places: (1) "Holy, Holy, Holy"; (2) "When thou tookest . . . born of a Virgin"; and (3) "And we worship . . . world without end." All make a genuflexion at the words, "We therefore pray thee . . . with thy precious Blood."

§ 13. *The Old Testament Canticles at Matins.*

THE Old Testament Canticles given in this volume (p. 379) are taken from the old Roman Divine Office, where they are appointed as the fourth Psalm at Lauds throughout the week. There are two for each day, one festal (i.e. said on all feasts) and one ferial (said on non-feast days and in penitential seasons).

The Prayer Book alternatives to the *Te Deum*, *Benedicite* (p. 367) and *Benedictus es* (p. 375), were originally derived from this set of canticles. In the old Breviary system, they were appointed as the festal and ferial canticles on Sundays, respectively.

Following the Prayer Book placement and use of the *Benedicite* and *Benedictus es*, these additional Old Testament Canticles may be used in place of the *Te Deum* on weekdays when that hymn is not said.

There are two options for an Old Testament canticle each day – one “festal” and one “ferial.” It is suggested that the “ferial” canticles, being more penitential in character, may be used on ferias in Advent and Lent, and on Ember Days, Rogation Days, and Vigils. Likewise, the “festal” canticles may be used on ferias in non-penitential seasons (during the times after Epiphany and Trinity).

It should be noted that these Old Testament canticles, other than the *Benedicite* and *Benedictus es*, should be seen as an extra feature of this volume and not at all essential to the Prayer Book Daily Office.

§ 14. *The Magnificat at Evensong.*

AT this point in Evensong, after the first lesson, and the Office Hymn (if it is sung), there follows the canticle *Magnificat anima mea* (p. 437). All stand for the *Magnificat*, and bow towards the Altar at the words “And holy is his Name.” At solemn Evensong, during the *Magnificat*, the Altar is censed by the Priest with his assistants, in the same manner as in the Mass.

There are many settings provided for the *Magnificat* in this volume, some of them solemn (marked with an “S”), and some simple. The solemn settings may be preferred on Sundays and greater feasts, while the simple settings may be preferred on ferias and lesser feasts. At the *Magnificat*, as at all Gospel canticles, the intonation to the tone is sung throughout the canticle, at the beginning of each verse.

According to ancient precedent, the *Magnificat* is always sung as the evening Cantic. The alternatives given in the Prayer Book are never used. Hence, they are not included in this volume.

§ 15. *Canticle Antiphons.*

It is desirable (at least on solemn occasions) for the Gospel Canticle at Matins and Evensong to be sung with its proper Antiphon before and after. The appropriate Antiphons on *Magnificat* and *Benedictus*, set to their proper plain-song tunes, may be found in *The Monastic Diurnal Noted* (available from Lancelot Andrewes Press).

According to the medieval custom, the Antiphon is "doubled", that is, sung in full before and after the Canticle, only on Feasts of Double rank. In lesser Offices, only that part of the Antiphon before the dagger or asterisk is sung before the Canticle; and after the Canticle the whole Antiphon is sung. A more ancient practice, however, is for the Antiphon to be said entire both before and after, at all Offices of whatever rank.

When the Antiphon text is taken from the Canticle's first verse (in part or in full), the words are not repeated in the Canticle chant itself. Instead, the text is continued straight on, except when *Alleluia* is interposed at the end of the Antiphon text (in which case the usual rule is followed).

§ 16. *The Second Lesson.*

A SECOND Lesson, from the New Testament, selected according to the lectionary system of the community, is read in both Matins and Evensong at this point. The comments which were made above on the first lesson (pp. 234-235) also apply to the second.

§ 17. *The Office Hymn.*

As the Prayer Book Office of Morning Prayer actually contains elements of the medieval hour of Lauds as well as Matins, the Office Hymn can either retain the ancient Matins placement in the Breviary (after the *Venite* and before the Psalms of the Day); or, after the first lesson and preceding the first Canticle (*Te Deum* or O.T. Canticle). The latter practice, however, seems more natural according to the Prayer Book order. At Evensong, the Office Hymn follows the first lesson and precedes the *Magnificat*.

Following the ancient Latin system, proper Office Hymns are appointed according to specific seasons and feasts. The Office Hymn of a particular office must correspond with the first Collect (of the day) of that office. Hence, the proper Latin Office Hymns of the Breviary (in English translation) should be sung as often as possible, and if possible according to the ancient plainchant, rather than modern tunes.

The Office Hymns for use with this volume may, for the most part, be found in publications such as *The English Hymnal*, and the recently published *Saint Ambrose Hymnal*. The *1940 Hymnal* and *Hymns Ancient and Modern* also contain a number of them.

An Office Hymn is not sung on the last three days of Holy Week, nor in the Office of the Dead.

§ 18. *The Benedictus at Matins.*

At this point in Matins, after the second lesson, there follows the canticle *Benedictus Dominus Deus Israel* (p. 397). All stand for the *Benedictus*. At solemn Matins, the Altar is censed during the *Benedictus* by the Priest with his assistants, in the same manner as in the Mass.

As with the Magnificat, there are a great many different settings provided for the *Benedictus*, some of them solemn (marked with an "S"), and some are simple. The solemn settings may be preferred on Sundays and greater feasts, while the simple settings may be preferred on ferias and lesser feasts. As with all Gospel canticles, the intonation to the tone is sung throughout the canticle, at the beginning of each verse.

According to ancient precedent, the *Benedictus* is always sung, and never replaced with the Prayer Book alternatives (even on St. John Baptist Day, when the text of the *Benedictus* is included in the second lesson).

§ 19. *The Nunc dimittis at Evensong.*

At this point in Evensong, after the second lesson, there follows the canticle *Nunc dimittis* (p. 475). All stand for the *Nunc*. The only settings provided for the *Nunc* are simple settings. As with all Gospel canticles, the intonation to the tone is sung throughout the canticle, at the beginning of each verse.

The singing of the *Nunc* is never omitted from Evensong and replaced with the Prayer Book alternatives, except when Compline is to follow as a separate Office. In this case, either the *Deus misereatur* (Ps. 67) or the *Benedic anima mea* (Ps. 103) would be sung.

§ 20. *An Optional Third Lesson.*

If it is thought desirable, a third lesson from the Church Fathers or the lives of the Saints may be added here between the second Canticle and the Creed. Appropriate seasonal and festal readings from patristic and hagiographical sources may be found, in English, as appointed for Matins in the *Anglican Breviary*.

§ 21. *The Creeds.*

In both Matins and Evensong, after last canticle, the Apostles' Creed (p. 248) is here intoned by the Officiant and chanted by all, monotone (*recto tono*). All stand for the recitation of the creed. According to custom and some authorities, all face liturgical East (toward the Altar). At the end of the Creed, all make the Sign of the Cross at the indicated place.

According to the 1662 English Prayer Book, on certain days, only at Matins, instead of the Apostles' Creed, the Athanasian Creed, or *Quicunque vult*, is recited (p. 429). The particular days on which it is recited are mentioned in the rubric introducing the section. Although in the 1662 Prayer Book, it replaces the Creed, it is not properly a creed, and the old Roman Office included it in the number of the Psalms on certain days at Prime. According to this precedent, the *Quicunque vult* is best chanted antiphonally, as a Psalm would, according to the Psalm tones provided.

§ 22. *The Salutation, Kyrie, and Lord's Prayer.*

THEN, after the Creed, at both Matins and Evensong, is said the salutation "The Lord be with you," if the Officiant is in major holy orders. If the Officiant is a layman or a clerk in minor orders, he should instead say the verse "O Lord, hear our prayer" with its response. After the response, all, except an Officiant in major holy orders, kneel for the chanting of the *Kyrie* and the Lord's Prayer (pp. 248-249).

§ 23 *The Suffrages, or Preces.*

AFTER the Lord's Prayer, the Suffrages (p. 250) are chanted antiphonally by the Officiant and the congregation (the former chanting the words preceded by "V" and the latter chanting the words preceded by "R"). According to the 1928 American Prayer Book, at Matins only the first and last set of verses are chanted (beginning "O Lord, show thy mercy upon us" and "O God, make clean our hearts within us"). The people should continue to kneel throughout. An Officiant who is in major holy orders stands, whereas Officiants who are minor clerks and laymen kneel along with the people.

§ 24. *The Collect of the Day and Commemorations.*

AFTER the Suffrages, the proper Collect of the Day and any other proper Collects of commemoration are chanted. The first Collect is always the proper one appointed for the Sunday, feast or feria of the day. It should be sung

according to one of the Collect tones (pp. 276, or 281), as the second and third Collects are. On penitential days, the Collects may be sung on a monotone (*recto tono*), without inflections.

The most essential collection of proper Collects for the Sundays and some major feasts can be found in the Prayer Book. However, other Collects for feast days (both major and minor), as well as proper Collects for Lenten ferias, may be found in traditional English translations of the Roman Office such as *The Monastic Diurnal* (edited by Canon Winfred Douglas, now reprinted by Lancelot Andrewes Press) or *The Anglican Breviary*.

Other feasts and observances with proper Collects should be commemorated after the first Collect, and before the second and third Collects. Collects are thus read in order of importance, and according to the ranking of the observances they are attached to (for more on systems of ranking, see *The Monastic Diurnal* or *The Anglican Breviary*).

No other supplemental Prayers, other than the proper system of Collects, should be added to the Office at this point. Such supplemental prayers are in fact considered to be paraliturgical, and hence should come between the Closing Versicles and the Grace.

§ 25. The "Second" and "Third" Collects.

THESE sets of two Collects each (p. 251), said after the Collect of the Day and commemorations are proper to Matins and Evensong, are fixed and therefore should never be omitted. They are chanted according to the same Collect tone as the Collect of the Day. Settings of the fixed Collects according to the ancient and later tones may be found on p. 278 and 283, respectively. As with the Collect of the Day, these collects may also be sung on a monotone (*recto tono*) on penitential days.

§ 26. The Closing Versicles.

THIS set of verses (p. 252), beginning with the Salutation, including the *Benedicamus Domino*, and ending with the commemoration of the faithful departed, have been added to the Prayer Book Office from the Roman Office, and signal the dismissal and the end of the Office proper (like the *Ite missa est* in the Mass). There is a festal tone (sung on all Sundays and holy days outside of Eastertide), a ferial tone (sung on all non-feast days and penitential days), and a tone for Eastertide (sung on all Sundays, feasts and ferias in that season).

§ 27. *The Anthem.*

THE Prayer Book, at this point in Evensong, allows for "the Anthem" in "quires and places where they sing." The Anthem is commonly understood as a short text from Holy Scripture or some other pious source which may here be sung by the choir.

However, it is understood by many commentators that the "Anthem," as an old English word for "antiphon," is a remnant of the Marian Antiphons (or, "Final Antiphons") once sung at this point in the medieval Office. These special seasonal commemorations of the Blessed Virgin Mary consist of an Antiphon (intoned by the Precentor), a Versicle and Response (sung by Officiant and people), and a Collect (chanted by the Officiant).

These texts may be found at the end of this volume in their simple plainchant settings (p. 491).

§ 28. *The Supplementary Prayers and the Grace.*

INTERPRETING the Prayer Book Office according to ancient precedents, these extra prayers (p. 253) are not a part of the Office proper, and thus are considered to be paraliturgical. They should be read after the Closing Versicles and Anthem (if sung), but before the Grace. The Officiant reads these prayer in the normal voice. He is not limited only to those prayers given on these pages, but may add any other prayers, supplications, litanies, or thanksgivings "as he shall think fit," taken from other sources.

The Office, although according to medieval precedent properly ending with the Closing Versicles, concludes with the reading of the Grace (in a normal voice) by the Officiant, at which time all make the Sign of the Cross.

§ 29. *Summaries of the Office throughout the Year.*

THE following summary lists of the details and rules of arranging the Offices on different liturgical days may be of help to those reciting the Daily Office.

THE ORDINARY SUNDAY OFFICE :

Psalms of the Day (monthly scheme)

Lessons of the day (regular scheme)

Office Hymn of the season

Te Deum at Matins (except O.T. Canticle in Advent and Lent)

Collect of the Sunday, and other seasonal or festal commemorations

THE SUNDAY OFFICE IN CHRISTMASTIDE, EPIPHANYTIDE, ASCENSIONTIDE, AND IN THE OCTAVE OF CORPUS CHRISTI :

Psalms of the Day (monthly scheme)
Lessons of the day (regular scheme)
Office Hymn of the feast, season, or octave
Te Deum at Matins
Collect of the Sunday, and other seasonal or festal commemorations

THE FESTAL OFFICE (ON GREATER FEASTS, INCLUDING SUNDAYS) :

Proper Psalms of the Feast, or Psalms of the Day (monthly scheme)
Proper Lessons of the Feast, or Lessons of the day (regular scheme)
Office Hymn of the feast
Te Deum at Matins (except on Holy Innocents' Day, when an O.T. Canticle is used)
Collect of the Feast, and other seasonal or Sunday commemorations

THE FESTAL OFFICE (ON LESSER FEASTS) :

Psalms of the Day (monthly scheme)
Lessons of the day (regular scheme)
Office Hymn of the feast
Te Deum at Matins (or, O.T. Canticle)
Collect of the Feast, and other seasonal, festal or ferial commemorations

THE FERAL OFFICE (ON WEEKDAYS WHICH ARE NOT FEAST DAYS) :

Psalms of the Day (monthly scheme)
Lessons of the day (regular scheme)
Office Hymn of the day of the week, or of the season
O.T. Canticle at Matins (or *Te Deum* only in Eastertide and Christmastide)
Collect of preceding Sunday, or proper ferias, and other seasonal commemorations